SLOW-ROASTED TURKEY BREAST
WITH SAND PLUM SAUCE

serves 8

Sand plums, also known as sandhill plums or Chickasaw plums, grow on a shrubby plant called *Prunus angustifolia* in Oklahoma and other dry prairie areas. While they do grow wild, some people cultivate them in their gardens.

Of course, humans aren't the only ones who love this sweet fruit, which grows throughout the summer. Birds enjoy it, too. To beat the birds to a delicious harvest, pick the fruit while it's still yellow or just starting to blush orange, then allow it to ripen for a few days at room temperature.

Most people turn their sand plums into a sweet jelly set with pectin. When lightly sweetened, as they are here, sand plums create a nice sauce for different kinds of game meats, including wild turkey.

Gently roasting the herbed turkey breast with some stock keeps it moist.

TURKEY

2½ tablespoons coarse sea salt

2 teaspoons dried wild bergamot (bee balm)

2 teaspoons ground sumac

1 bone-in turkey breast (7 to 9 pounds)

2 leeks, white and light-green parts only, coarsely chopped and rinsed of grit

4 cups Roasted Bird Stock (page 40)

SAUCE

2 pounds sand plums, other wild plums, or small reddish plums (slightly bigger than a cherry), plus a few pitted plums, for garnish

¼ cup honey or agave syrup

Pinch of sea salt

Fresh wild bergamot (bee balm) leaves or flowers or other wild herbs, for garnish

Roast the turkey: In a small bowl, mix together the salt, bergamot, and sumac. Use it to season the turkey all over and let stand at room temperature for 1 to 2 hours or refrigerate, uncovered, for up to 2 days.

If the turkey has been refrigerated, let it stand at room temperature for 1 to 2 hours before roasting.

Preheat the oven to 275°F.

Transfer the turkey to a roasting pan breast-side up. Add the leeks to the pan and pour in the stock. Insert a probe thermometer in the thickest part of the breast near where the wings were attached but away from the bone. Cover the turkey with parchment paper followed by aluminum foil, sealing the edges of the pan. (You will need to use a couple of sheets of each.)

Slow-roast for 2½ to 3 hours, until the thermometer registers 165°F. Remove the turkey from the oven to rest for 20 minutes. Reserve some of the pan juices.

Meanwhile, make the sauce: Using a cherry pitter or a paring knife, remove the pits from the plums. Put 1 inch of water in a large saucepan and add most of the pitted plums. Bring the water to a boil over medium-high heat, cover, and cook for about 10 minutes, just to soften them. Let the plums cool slighly and drain.

Working in batches as needed, transfer the softened plums to a blender and puree.

Pour into the empty saucepan and add the honey and a pinch of salt. Cook over medium heat, stirring frequently, for about 5 minutes, or until it's thickened to a spoonable consistency.

Slice the rested turkey breast and brush on a little bit of the reserved pan juices in the bottom of the pan to keep it moist.

Spoon the plum sauce on a platter. Arrange the turkey on top. Garnish with pitted plums and wild bergamot.